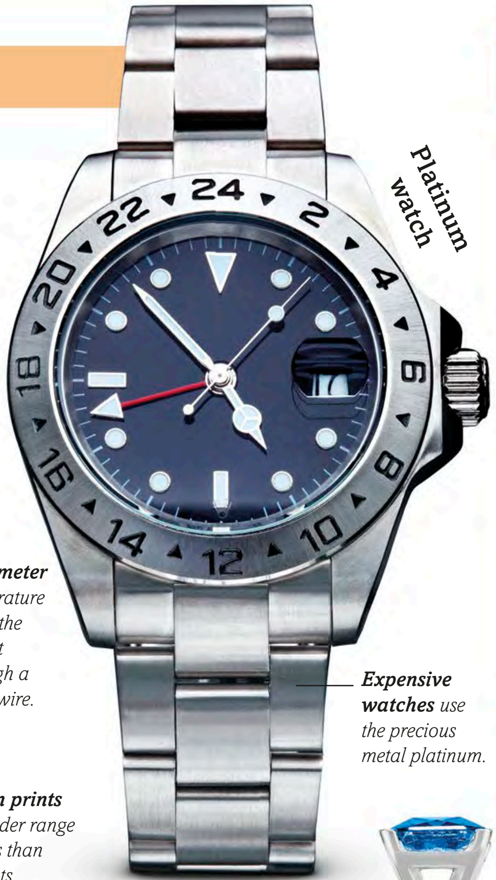
Uses

Platinum resistance thermometer

This thermometer *records temperature by measuring the electric current flowing through a fine platinum wire.*

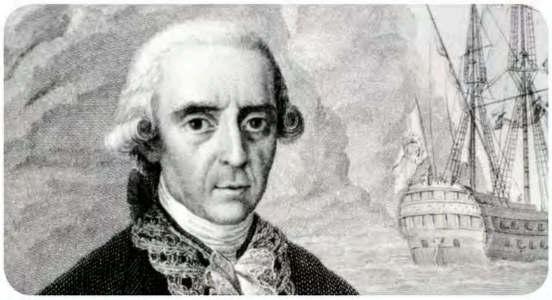


Platinum watch

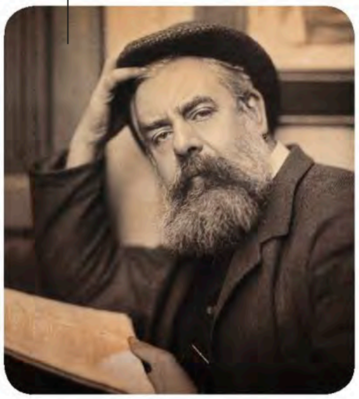
Expensive watches *use the precious metal platinum.*

ANTONIO DE ULLOA

Although platinum had been in use in jewellery on the west coast of South America for more than 2,000 years, it was Spanish naval officer Antonio de Ulloa who made the first major study of it. In 1735, while on a South American expedition, he found grains of the metal in river sands. He brought them back to Spain to examine them.



Platinum prints *have a wider range of shades than silver prints.*

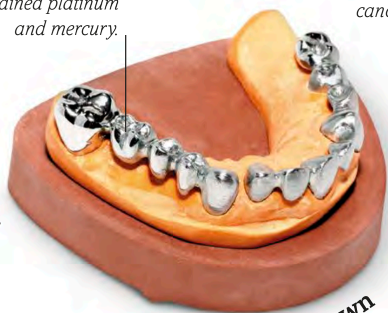


Black and white photographic print

Platinum ring

Jewellery *made of platinum does not lose its shine.*

Dental fillings *once contained platinum and mercury.*

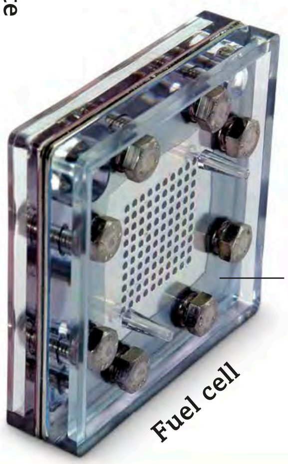


Dental crown

This drug *contains platinum and kills cancer cells in the body.*

Cancer drug

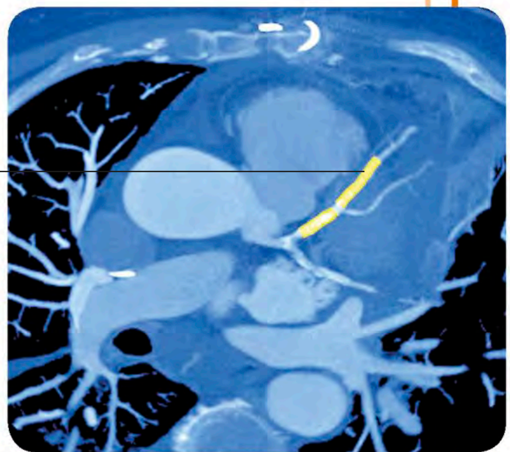
Platinum was found in an Egyptian casket from the **7th century BCE**.



Fuel cell

This fuel cell *contains platinum, which speeds up the reaction between hydrogen and oxygen.*

This stent made of platinum *is not harmful to the body and anchors a damaged blood vessel as it heals.*



Medical stent

more applications were discovered. Platinum can be used in place of silver to generate **photographic prints**, and in place of gold for making **dental fillings**. Today, platinum plays an important role in various technologies. For example, it is used in **fuel cells** – devices that generate electricity by combining hydrogen and oxygen. These cells do not need to be recharged like other batteries. Powerful **drugs for treating cancer** contain this element, while **stents** made of pure platinum help heal damaged blood vessels.